

Now let's say you already have started drawing a line and want it to end at an exact coordinate in the 3D drawing area—and you even know the exact coordinates of the endpoint. Simply type in the coordinates enclosed in square brackets and the line will stretch out till the endpoint you have specified. Please note that these coordinates are absolute—in the sense that they must be according to the points on the three axes.

Occasionally, you know where you'd like the line to end, but don't know the exact three dimensional coordinates. Just feed into the VCB the x, y and z values—that is the relative distances from the starting point of the line you are drawing. Note that these coordinates have nothing to do with the units and points on the three axes, but are relative units of distance from the start point of the line to the end point of the line.

Relative coordinates (relative to the starting point of the line) must always be typed in the VCB enclosed by angle brackets.

Using the VCB for Arcs

When drawing an arc, the value you see in the VCB is the chord length of the arc. Again, this is only displayed once you have set the starting point of the arc.

Once you set the ending point of the arc, the value you see in the VCB is the bulged distance.

You can specify exact lengths for chords, bulges, radius and number of segments.

- **Chord Length:** You could specify exactly how large your arc should be by specifying the chord length. By default, any value you type into the VCB after placing the starting point of an arc will be accepted as the chord length of the arc. You'll see the VCB label "Length" on the status bar below (right) to indicate that you can now fill in the length of your chord.
- **Negative Chord lengths:** If you want SketchUp to draw the arc in a direction opposite to the current drawing direction, you'll have to type in a negative value.
- **Controlling the Bulge:** Once you've placed the starting and the ending point of your arc, the VCB will accept any value as the bulge (amount of curvature of the arc). To ensure that you